

The Tantra Called the Lotus Crown

Padmamukutaṅtra nāma · Toh 701 · Derge Kangyur

པདྨ་མུ་ཀུ་ཏྲ་ན་མ་ཏཱ་ཏི་ཏཱ་ལྷ་མོ་པོ་འཇམ་མཁའ་འཁོར་པའི་རྒྱུད།

The Tantra Called the Lotus Crown, known in Sanskrit as the Padmamukutaṅtra and in Tibetan as Padma Cod pan zhes bya ba'i rgyud, is a tantric scripture belonging to the Kangyur, where it is catalogued as Toh 701. It is a tantric text set in a celestial palace where the Buddha, manifest in the enjoyment body, enters into a state of meditative absorption radiating great compassion, with light touching the vast realm of Vairocana and making offerings to thousands of buddhas of the Good Aeon. The text thus situates itself within a richly cosmological and devotional framework characteristic of Buddhist tantric literature, with its homage directed to Mañjuśrī. It was translated into Tibetan by the monk-translator Parisgyur.

Translated and established by the monk-translator Parisgyur.

In Sanskrit: Padmamukutaṅtra nāma. In Tibetan: The Tantra Called the Lotus Crown.

Homage to the Blessed One, Mañjuśrī (the Gentle Vajra).

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One, having become a buddha in the saṃbhogakāya (the enjoyment body) within the divine measureless palace, dwelt together with a retinue of innumerable bodhisattvas. Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "Radiating through Every Gateway of Great Compassion." Rays of light touched the dust-motes of the vast oceanic realm of Vairocana, and by that very touch made offerings to twelve thousand buddhas of the Good Aeon. Those rays then dissolved into the crown of the Blessed One's head. The moment they dissolved, the Lord of Great Compassion, Avalokiteśvara — possessed of a thousand arms and a thousand eyes, his body white as the sun rising upon a snowy peak, the root face among his eleven faces white, the upper face yellow, the right face green, the left face red, and the three topmost faces black — the Blessed One's head appeared as though adorned with coral, and he smiled and gazed upon the noble Avalokiteśvara, the sovereign Lord of Great Compassion.

Then the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, pressed his palms together and addressed the Blessed One with this petition:

Reveal the body, the mantras, the activities,
and in particular the special ritual procedures.

Having made this request, the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, and then declared:

The form of this body is as follows.

By pure compassion, crystal clear,
standing in equanimity, he accomplishes the welfare of beings.

Three faces crystal-hued and white,
one of great blackness tinged with green,
one yellow, likewise one red — the Blessed One.

The sage is ever adorned with deer.

Peaceful, smiling, and laughing,
with a wrathful face too — three eyes, beautiful.

The tenth is he who bears the bodhisattva's marks;
the eleventh is the Blessed One himself as sovereign.

A garland of jewel-like pearls of virtues,
activities of every kind draped at the lower body.

The first pair of hands is pressed in salutation;
the right holds a jeweled rosary,
the left holds a stainless lotus.

A right hand bestows supreme gifts;
a left hand pours ablution from a flask.

A right hand firmly holds a wheel;
at the side a left hand holds bow and arrow.

The remaining hands bestow supreme gifts and bear eyes.

Then once more the Blessed One smiled, and brilliant rays of light burst forth from the two crowns. And upon the Blessed One, from a lotus born of the blessing of all the buddhas, the five families appeared, namely: Vairocana, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha, Amoghasiddhi, and Akṣobhya. Within that precious multi-storied mansion appeared a lion, a horse, a peacock, a garuḍa, and an elephant — these arose from the crown. Further, the Mother is of blue body, born from a lotus and standing upon a lotus seat, beautiful with four arms and the four immeasurables, adorned with bodhisattva ornaments, seated in the posture of equanimity. The Father is of golden body, born from a lotus and standing upon a lotus seat, his palms pressed together, holding a jeweled counting-rosary, fully adorned with ornaments.

Further, with rays fully spread wide:

From the moon and sun arises
a solar one, sun-hued, youthful, bestowing supreme gifts of the blue lotus.
Born from the moon, sky-hued,
slightly wrathful, bearing a vajra.
White as white snow,
upon the sun and moon, holding a lotus.
From the two fierce ones and from the syllable Hrīḥ,
the fruit is perfected in the manner of non-duality.
Hayagrīva gathers the three realms.

Performing the enlightened activity of the wrathful furrowed-brow aspect, Yamāntaka holds the treasure-store and vanquishes the armies of māra, conqueror of the three realms. Upon a pure white wheel with four sides, four gates, and archways: first comes supreme devotion to the Three Jewels, the four immeasurables are perfectly complete, the limbs of awakening are perfected, and the dharmadhātu's intrinsic nature is emptiness.

This is the first chapter, setting forth the occasion and the bodies.

Then, in order to teach the secret mantras, the Blessed One radiated light throughout all the buddha-fields of Vairocana's vast ocean, and it was absorbed into the crown of his head. Then he spoke again:

Oṃ Hūṃ Trāṃ Hrīḥ Āḥ. Namo ratnatrayāya. Namo ārya-jñānasāgarāya Vairocana-vyūharājāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ arhadbhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhebhyaḥ. Namo ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, iṭṭe vaṭṭe, cale cale, pracale pracale, kusume kusumavare, ili mili, citi jvala mapanaya svāhā.

Any son or daughter of noble family who recites this mantra even once, or recalls and holds it in mind, or wears it upon the body, will be purified of the five acts of immediate retribution and the sinful deeds proximate to them, and will not be reborn in hell, among hungry ghosts, in the realm of animals, or in any of the eight states of misfortune accompanied by suffering. They will be freed from all predatory beasts, rākṣasas, non-human beings, sickness, and every danger. And protection may also be accomplished with Oṃ rakṣa rakṣa.

With the formula Oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarvadharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāt, torma water is to be offered to hungry ghosts, accomplished with Oṃ Āḥ Hūṃ.

The condensed mantra of all these is: Oṃ maṇi padme hūṃ.

This becomes the lord of the three family-lineages, and its benefit is as follows: one will behold the great compassion of the dharmakāya and the form body.

Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-dhūpe pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-puṣpe pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-āloke pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-gandhe pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-naivedye pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-śabde pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ. Oṃ namaḥ sarva-tathāgata-maṇḍala-pūja-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ.

Then, truly making offering through offerings:

Arisen from emptiness-wisdom,
endowed with both skillful means and wisdom,
recite perfectly the white syllable Hrīḥ.

This is the second chapter, the chapter on mantras.

In order to set forth the rites and ceremonies: for accomplishing the first, the peaceful activity, in a pleasing grove, at the initial brightening of the white fortnight, anoint it well with fragrant water, strew white flowers, and, having prepared ablutions and food conforming to the direction, sit upon a comfortable seat. Fill a white vase with white sandalwood fragrance, wind it well with cloth, and place it carefully at the center of the maṇḍala. Meditate on the bodhisattva's body arising from the syllable Hrīḥ: one face, two hands, body white in color, complete with ornaments, holding a lotus, seated beautifully upon a moon-seat. Meditate on rays of light streaming forth from the syllable Hrīḥ; likewise with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes. Visualizing the vast body before you, as the light from Hrīḥ radiates outward and is gathered back in brilliant clarity, that is the radiant clarity of recitation. Then recite this secret mantra:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō ārya-jñānasāgara-Vairocana-vyūharājāya tathāgatāya arhate samyakṣambuddhāya. Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ arhadbhyaḥ samyakṣambuddhebhyaḥ.

Namas ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Amitabha-la-che-ge-mo śānti-kuru svāhā.

Recite this mantra. Then:

Brum̐.

Whoso is bathed aright in Vairocana's vase-water
shall be utterly cleansed of every stain,
and shall attain the fruit of bliss.
Fully freed from every fear,
swiftly shall they attain the water-born.

Now, if one wishes to accomplish the rite of increase, go into a very dense forest, anoint it well with fragrant water, and strew flowers together with their fruits. Examine all the adornments, then sit comfortably upon a pleasant seat. Take the five precious substances along with grains, pour them into a precious vessel, and place it well at the center of the maṇḍala.

The bodhisattva's body arisen from Hrīḥ:
one face, two hands, body golden in color,
complete with ornaments, holding a lotus,
and likewise with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes.
Visualize before you the body of increase,
and make perfect offering with the five offerings.
Recite with brilliant clarity the radiance and gathering of Hrīḥ.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaḥ ārya-jñānasāgarāya Vairocana-vyūharājāya
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ
arhadbhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhebhyaḥ. Namas ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya
bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Ratna-kuna-puṣṭim̐ kuru svāhā.
Place it upon an empty treasury, and it shall be filled to the brim with grain.

Now, if one wishes to perform the rite of magnetizing, go to the bank of a gathering river, fashion pills from red palāśa and aśvattha flowers, insert them into a red tortoise-shell, and make offering with red flowers.

Tārā arisen from Hrīḥ:
green, holding an iron hook in her hand,
likewise with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes.
Visualize before you the body of increase,
and make perfect offering with the five offerings.
Recite with brilliant clarity the radiance and gathering of Hrīḥ.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaḥ ārya-jñānasāgarāya Vairocana-vyūharājāya
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ

arhadbhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhebhyaḥ. Namas ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Amoghabhāsmiṃ kuru. Oṃ tāre tuttāre ture amoghabhāsmiṃ kuru svāhā.

Anoint the body with the key of substances, and by that anointing one shall be drawn in.

Now, if one wishes to perform the rite of subjugation, anoint a single cremation-ground tree well with cow's fat, and strew five incense-bundles of blue flowers of the nīpa tree. Sit facing north and undertake this rite.

Above the predator, a crystal ball. Arisen from the syllable Hrīḥ:
white in color, with matted hair piled high,
one face, three eyes,
holding a deer-skin,
in the appearance of a wrathful sage.

The first of four hands bestows the supreme gift;
the left, upon a lotus, holds a sword;
the right, a spear adorned with a running-knot design,
topped with three white points;
the left, a white skull
filled with fragrant flowers,
gazing sidelong, in the manner of a great king.
Likewise with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes,
the thousand buddhas of the Fortunate Aeon
beautifully seated upon lotus-thrones —
visualize well the body of increase,
and recite the king of secret mantras arisen from the radiance and gathering
of Hrīḥ.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaḥ ārya-jñānasāgarāya Vairocana-vyūharājāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ arhadbhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhebhyaḥ. Namas ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ akaṭe nikaṭe kiṭakaṭe karoṭe karoṭa vīrye svāhā.

Oṃ karma amoghā, bi vajra siṃha nādi hūṃ phaṭ.

Into incense or anointing oils infuse it,
then anoint the body with that mixture.

Place blue flowers upon the head,
anoint the body with maṇḍala water.

Having recited twenty-five times,
all activities will be accomplished.

Then, if one wishes to accomplish all four,
at an auspicious time, when the three periods of day are complete,
in a pleasing, beautiful place on a mountain,
having properly prepared the ground,
arrange a fine maṇḍala and scatter
white fragrant flowers throughout.
Lay out the pure and clean substances.
Set in place one who is a pure brahmin.
Abiding upon a ritual bath-mat of kuśa grass,
upon the lotus born of Hrīḥ —
three faces resembling the color of clear water,
bearing a smiling and peaceful nature:
three faces of a gentle, laughing green,
one face black and wrathful, with reddish-yellow hair,
the yellow face smiling,
and the red face crowned with the Blessed One's head —
the upper body draped in a deer-skin,
wearing a variegated lower garment,
standing evenly on two feet with six hands:
the first right and left in añjali — palms joined in reverence;
the middle hands holding a lotus and a counting rosary;
the final hands holding the supreme gift and a flask for aspersion;
the vase; Vairocana; the goddess Lāsyā, Mālyā, Gītā, Nṛtyā —
the inner goddesses of Nṛtyā —
beautifully seated upon lunar thrones.

Recite the king of secret mantras arisen from the syllable Hrīḥ.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaḥ ārya-jñānasāgarāya Vairocanāya vyūharājāya
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namaḥ sarvatathāgatebhyaḥ
arhadbhyaḥ samyaksaṃbuddhebhyaḥ. Namaḥ ārya-Avalokiteśvarāya
bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ dhara dhara,
dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, iṭṭe vaṭṭe, cale cale, pracale pracale, kusume
kusumavare, ili mili citi jvala mapanaye svāhā.

Having properly consecrated the water in the vase,
by anointing the body with it all will be accomplished.

This is the third chapter, on the accomplishment through ritual procedure.

Then the gradual method of means:

On barley, cloth, or tree bark,
draw with goat's milk
a five-cluster wheel.

At the center, the seed syllable of the body —
the fifth of the fifth —
write that in the east.

The fifth of the fourth marks the center.

Set that correctly in the south.

The first of the fifth, the third of the fourth —
set that correctly in the west.

The fifth of the fifth, combined with the vowel e —
set that correctly in the north.

At the center, the seed syllable of the mind —
śāntiṃ kuru at the borders.

Svāhā — place that at the center.

Having thus set out the wheel clearly,
insert it into a silver or white capsule.
All activities whatsoever will be pacified.

Written with turmeric water:

puṣṭiṃ kuru at the borders.

Insert it well into a yellow bowl
of fragrant white sandalwood.

The activities of increase will be accomplished.

Written well with palāśa wood:

vaśaṃ kuru — place at the borders.

Insert it well into a red bowl.

The activities of power will be accomplished.

Written well with neem water:

mārayā — place at the borders.

Insert it properly into iron or a skull.

All activities of wrath will be accomplished.

Fragrant white sandalwood —
for pacification, burn it in fire.

Wood bearing sweet fruit —
for increase, burn it in fire.
For power, palāśa wood —
burning it will bring one under control.
Neem wood cut with sharp strokes —
burning it accomplishes wrathful activities.
This is the fourth chapter, on the wheel.

Then the gradual sequence of activities:
Dūrvā grass and rice husks,
sesame and white mustard, cizā —
having recited the secret mantra over these and accomplished them,
burning them well on dāli wood
is able to pacify everything completely.

Kuśa grass, the star-apple, the juniper berry,
and red śāla flowers —
recite the secret mantra diligently over them,
then burn them well on sandalwood.
The activities of increase will be accomplished,
and the supreme power will be attained.

Palāśa wood,
along with barley, cizā, and kidney beans —
recite the secret mantra diligently over these,
then burn them on padmaka wood.
The supreme power will be attained,
and everything will come under one's control.

Wheat, turnip, rice,
barley, kidney beans, and black sesame —
recite the secret mantra diligently over these,
then burn them on khadira wood.
Endowed with power, all those activities
will be swiftly accomplished.

On prakhā and khatsa wood,
together with their leaves and fruits,
and on vajra wood, having recited the mantra,
burn them on the wood of the nirvāṇa tree.

Having attained the power, one swiftly
brings all people under one's control.

The root of the blue lotus,
and mūlapattra wood —
having recited the secret mantra diligently over these,
burn them on aruṇa wood.
By placing them beneath the wheel,
kings are brought under one's control.

Palāśa wood
and the fruit of the oleander —
having recited the secret mantra diligently over these,
burn them thoroughly on jambū wood.
Then, by placing them beneath a sword,
the lord of battle too is brought under one's control.

Bones a hundred lifetimes old,
and bones pierced by weapons —
having recited the secret mantra diligently over these,
burn them thoroughly in a fire of kyera wood.
Then, by placing them firmly beneath an iron hook,
elephants will be brought under one's control.

Bāleṭa, tāleśa,
khadira, and dādhima —
burn these well on charnel-ground wood,
and tigers and the like are brought under one's control.

With barley, rice, and turnip,
with medicines and various precious substances,
make a well-formed circular maṇḍala.
Offer it to the perfectly adorned buddha
born from the lotus of crystal water —
crystal-hued, bearing a gentle smile,
seated in vajra posture,
dwelling on a seat of kuśa grass, facing east.
With the lotus mudrā, offer with a mind of loving-kindness.
This repels illness, plague, pox,
scabies, rashes, fire-blight,

all disease and all harmful spirits.

It reverses the fruits of the five acts of immediate retribution, of non-virtue, and the suffering of disease.

This is the fifth chapter, on the fire activities.

Then, against the danger of kings:

Make a well-formed white maṇḍala,
anoint it with the scent of white sandalwood,
and with ablution water and white flowers
and whatever offerings are available,
offer to the form of a king-like figure.
Confess all wrongdoings before it,
then swiftly take refuge.

Make images of kings from clay or bark,
inscribe them with the five syllables,
bind them thoroughly with five-colored threads,
and, with a mind of loving-kindness, cast them into a river —
by this one is freed from the punishment of kings.

Oṃ hūṃ trāṃ hrīḥ aḥ śo na hari ma ka to, sa ra sa ra ka ra ka ra svāhā.

When the danger of wild beasts approaches:

Make a well-formed white maṇḍala,
scatter white flowers abundantly,
offer to the king-figure with the five offerings,
confess wrongdoings, and swiftly take refuge.

Five types of grain and five types of precious substances,
five pegs made of five-colored thread —
having made them and attached them to the body,
one will swiftly be freed from all dangers of wild beasts.

Oṃ āḥ hūṃ trāṃ hrīḥ śo śa na hari ha tir ma ka ro sa ra sa ra ka ra ka ra svāhā.

Against the danger of thieves:

Take refuge in the sacred site of the one bearing blue flowers and vajra,
dark indigo, pressing the earth with his hand as mudrā.

Oṃ akṣobhyaḥ ta ka ka ra na ga ra kha ti pa sva dhi ca kri ta ya ri ka ce ca tra ti na dur ta na, sa ra sa ra ka ra ka ra svāhā.

Against the danger of snake venom:

With a Nepalese cane whip,
meditate on the adornment in the form of a brahmin
and visualize the form endowed with the precious source.
On the crown of the head: pearl, coral,
crystal, ruby,
indranīla, a right-coiling conch,
gold, silver, and dūrvā grass,
the eight precious substances, along with grain,
kuśa grass, spikenard, sandalwood,
willow, kyser wood, and blue lotus,
saffron, and sweet-smelling unguent — anoint the body.

Om̐ ratna sambhava sa, ti bi sha sa ra sa ra ka ra ka ra svāhā.

Against the danger of lightning strike:

powder of tiger bone and dragon bone,
powder of iron filings,
copper powder, goat-hoof powder,
and gold powder kneaded into dough —
meditate on the form of Amitābha (the "Boundless Light" buddha),
show loving-kindness in all directions and quarters,
and fumigate with the smoke of various poisons.

Om̐ amṛta ba vajra jvāla vajra jvāla, garḍa garḍa, sa ra sa ra, ka ra ka ra
svāhā.

Against the danger of fire:

recite the mantra over dragon bone, senta-grass, sesame, sālu grain, cīce
plant,
barley, wheat, and grape clusters,
then scatter them in the direction of the fire.

Om̐ vairocana prabhā jvāla jvāla, sa ra sa ra, ka ra ka ra svāhā.

Meditate on the form of Vairocana,
make a fire offering, and extinguish it with earth.

Against the danger of rivers:

into the skulls of male and female lepers,
place the blood of goat, dog, and pig,
together with images of the eight classes of earth lords,

then throw them into the river.

Meditate on the form of Amoghasiddhi (the "Infallible Accomplishment" buddha).

Om̐ amogha siddhi, Om̐ ka vaiṭāraṇi sa ra sa ra, ka ra ka ra svāhā.

The thousand hands and the thousand eyes are likewise —
the supreme form of great compassion:

visualize each one distinctly and clearly,
contemplate each one above each head,
gazing upon all with loving-kindness.
One shall be liberated from all dangers.

This is the sixth chapter: complete protection from all dangers.

Offer white flowers to the sacred relics.
Sprinkle the ground with fragrant water.

Make excellent offering and praise
to a stūpa containing relics
or a stūpa of one cubit's measure.

It has arisen as the support of compassion's form,
born from the gnosis of emptiness,
endowed with the four immeasurable miraculous powers,
the branches of awakening perfectly complete.

Stainless, white as a conch —
the four Great Kings are likewise.

The great awakening stūpa,
thirteen tiers high and crowned with its pinnacle,
with a rain of divine music,
an inexhaustible treasury of the sound of Dharma,
possessing the nature of the five precious substances —
mark it with pegs and hold it completely.

The great blessing of all the buddhas:
the merit of this, it is taught,
purifies in a mere instant
the five acts of immediate retribution, the ten non-virtues,
and the misdeeds born of affliction's dominance.

The utterly pure place
should be tended by one possessed of loving-kindness and compassion.

Let one of compassion sprung from the brahmin lineage
perform the enquiry.

With one's own mind especially settled,
set it before you and make offerings.

Correct in measure and color, fully pure and bright,
it should be pleasing.

Offerings of pleasing food —
avoiding the three white substances in their churned form,
and strictly avoiding meat, garlic, onion,
salt, and alcohol —
a crystal rosary, the heart of the lotus,
the bodhi-seed, and auspicious pearls,
those that burn not, parch not, and scorch not
should never be severed at any time.

This is the seventh chapter: on implements and reliance on sacred
commitments.

When performing various activities,
rely upon a book, or a cloth painting on unstitched cotton,
and oneself abiding with a mind of loving-kindness.

From the syllable Mūṃ arises the noble Mañjuśrī:
reddish-yellow, holding a blue lotus and a book,
seated in the posture of equanimity.

Within a golden vase
are the five precious substances together with the five grains.

Tadyathā: Om̐ dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, iṭṭe baṭṭe, cale cale,
pracale pracale, kusume kusume vare, ili mili, cite jvāla mapanaye svāhā.

If this is recited seven times in full,
all delusion will be pacified
and great wisdom will be attained.

Relying upon a cloth painting of a stūpa,
arrange a maṇḍala with fragrant incense and flowers.

With the three white substances and the three sweet substances,
together with rice, sesame, and white mustard,

On a white lotus root,
pills the size of juniper berries.

The lordly Avalokiteśvara,
born from the syllable Hrīḥ, is white in body,
holding a lotus in his hand, granting supreme boons,
seated in the bodhisattva posture.

Tadyathā: Om̐ dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, iṭṭe baṭṭe, cale cale,
pracale pracale, kusume kusume vare, ili mili, cite jvāla mapanaye svāhā.

Having recited the mantra over the pills,
eat them with a mind of loving-kindness.
The attachment of cyclic existence will be pacified,
and supreme well-being will be attained.

From a well-prepared blue maṇḍala,
with blue utpala flowers, neem,
aloe wood, sandalwood,
fill a vase with perfumed water.

Vajrapāṇi, wearing blue robes,
his body a slightly wrathful blue-green,
holds the vajra in his hand,
seated in the bodhisattva posture.

Tadyathā: Om̐ dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, iṭṭe baṭṭe, cale cale,
pracale pracale, kusume kusume vare, ili mili, cite jvāla mapanaye svāhā.

Vajrapāṇi, born from the syllable Hūṃ,
if one performs ablution with the water of the vase,
aversion will be thoroughly pacified,
and great patience will be attained.

This is the eighth chapter, on thoroughly pacifying poisons.

On cloth, birch bark, or tree bark,
draw a wheel with four spokes and a rim.

Dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru —
and the words "rakṣa rakṣa, O great one."

If this protection is worn upon the body,
one will be freed from illness, spirits, contagion,
and all terrifying diseases and spirits,
and perfect well-being will be complete.

On white thread, make knots,
and recite well seven, twenty-one,
or one hundred and eight times.
If this supreme protection is made,
by this supreme protection
one will be most excellently guarded.

Pearl, coral, precious gold,
camphor, saffron, musk,
aloe wood, and white resin —
these are to be fastened upon the heart.

Sandalwood, musk, saffron,
black bdellium, and powdered bone,
fashioned into a paste with cow's milk,
and anointed upon the three places —
by this anointing, one will be protected
from all fears of spirits and illness.

This is the ninth chapter, on the protective wheel.

For the complete protection from hail:
on a peg of acacia wood,
having recited the dhāraṇī mantra, one visualizes
in the center a body arisen from the syllable Hūṃ.
In the four directions, great wrathful ones:

To the east, Trailokyavijaya (Conqueror of the Three Realms),
white in body, blazing with a mass of fire,
making the threatening gesture with vajra and wheel.
Om̐ prajñāntakṛta hana hana hūṃ phaṭ.

To the south, the fierce Yamāntaka (Destroyer of Yama),
dark red, holding a jeweled mace.
Om̐ yamāntakṛt tiṣṭha tiṣṭha hūṃ phaṭ.

To the west, red Hayagrīva (Horse-Necked One),
holding a blazing vajra club.
Om̐ hayagrīva hulu hulu hūṃ phaṭ.

To the north, the wrathful-browed one,
blue-green, holding a sword.
Om̐ amogha kabhrīkuṭi bandha bandha hūṃ phaṭ.

Over the pegs in the four directions,
recite seven or twenty-one times.

Mix the droppings of a carnivore with white mustard,
and while reciting the secret mantra, scatter them into the sky.

Om vajrakrodha hulu hulu, tiṣṭha tiṣṭha, bandha bandha, hana hana hūṃ phaṭ.

This is the tenth chapter, on protection from hail.

Then the Blessed One emitted rays of light — rays emanating from his thousand hands and thousand eyes — of these kinds: white, red, black, green, and yellow. Those rays pervaded all six classes of beings and gave them relief.

Then the Four Great Kings, the gods of the Thirty-Three, the gods Free from Strife, the Joyful gods, the gods Delighting in Creation, the gods Wielding Power over Others' Creations, the gods of the Brahmā realm, and Brahmā's Retinue,

Brahmā's Ministers, Great Brahmā, Minor Light, Immeasurable Light, Luminous, Minor Virtue, Immeasurable Virtue, Abundant Virtue, Cloudless, Merit-Born, Great Fruit, Not Great, Not Afflicted, Clearly Seeing, Magnificent Vision, Akaniṣṭha, and all the other gods — these sons of the gods released a rain of offering clouds, and then the sons of the gods praised Avalokiteśvara in verse:

To the lord Avalokiteśvara, body of compassion,
whose thousand hands are the hands that liberate beings from affliction,
whose thousand eyes are the clear light of wisdom —
to you who work the welfare of all beings, we bow and offer praise.

After this praise was sung, the Blessed One's form of great compassion became invisible, and he appeared as the Blessed One Śākyamuni.

Then a son of the gods asked: "What are the benefits of this?" And the Blessed One declared:

Whoever holds this tantra in mind
shall be freed from illness, malevolent spirits, epidemics,
the terror of kings and wild beasts,
and shall be liberated from all fears.
Attachment, aversion, and delusion,
and all the sins of the five heinous acts and every non-virtue
shall be utterly pacified.
Freed from the hells, the lower realms of suffering,

and the eight conditions of no leisure,
one shall hear, retain, and meditate.
And one shall behold the Blessed One himself,
like the center of a stainless sky.

After the Blessed One had thus declared, the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara rose from his seat, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One, and said, "Excellent! Excellent!" Then he took his seat again. The five billion bodhisattvas and the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras rejoiced and offered great praise for what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the eleventh chapter of the tantra called The Lotus Crown.

Translated by the Indian master the paṇḍita Dharmaśrīmitra and the Tibetan translator, the monk Chökyi Zangpo; revised and established in final form.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "the Blessed One's head appeared as though adorned with coral" is unusual. The Tibetan reads literally "the Blessed One's head became as though coral were inlaid," which in context most likely refers to the reddish coral-like appearance of Avalokiteśvara's face arrangement atop the Blessed One's head — a visual description of the theophany. This is a somewhat compressed and unusual construction.

The compound "Radiating through Every Gateway of Great Compassion" is a samādhi name; it is given literally as it appears.

"The sage adorned with deer" refers to the ṛṣi crown ornament — a standard iconographic element of certain forms of Avalokiteśvara featuring the image of a seated sage with deer, sometimes identified as a small Amitābha figure in deer-hide; the Tibetan "ri dags" means deer or wild animal.

The identification of the two crowns from which rays burst forth may refer to the eleven-faced Avalokiteśvara's crown and the Blessed One's own crown; the text is elliptical here.

- The opening verse continues the description from the preceding passage and concerns Yamāntaka as a wrathful deity form performing enlightened activity, holding treasure, and conquering the three realms. The wheel described with four sides, four gates, and archways is the maṇḍala palace.

The phrase rendered "at the initial brightening of the white fortnight" refers to the first day of the waxing moon, the auspicious time for beginning peaceful rites.

The offering mantras follow a standard sevenfold offering sequence: incense, flowers, light, fragrance, food-offering, sound or music, and the maṇḍala offering, each expanding as an ocean-cloud of offerings to all Tathāgatas.

- The subjugation deity described here — white, three-eyed, matted hair, deer-skin, four arms, wrathful sage appearance — is a form closely resembling Śiva iconography deliberately incorporated into the sādhana's subjugation rite. The text makes no explicit identification, but

the iconographic elements are conventionally associated with that tradition in Indo-Tibetan tantric literature.

The phrase rendered "above the predator, a crystal ball" is terse and may indicate a visualization support or a ritual object placed on an animal-skin seat; the precise referent is ambiguous in this context.

The mantra syllable "Amitabha-la-che-ge-mo" contains what appears to be a hybrid Sanskrit-Tibetan element; the Tibetan "la-che-ge-mo" is difficult to reconstruct with certainty and may be a corrupt transmission of a longer Sanskrit phrase.

- The four goddesses Lāsyā, Mālyā, Gītā, and Nṛtyā are the four inner offering goddesses of the maṇḍala, standard in Avalokiteśvara tantric contexts. Their names are kept in Sanskrit as proper names.

The seed-syllable instructions in the wheel chapter are deliberately cryptic, referring to positional enumeration within the Sanskrit vowel and consonant sequences. The phrase "the fifth of the fifth" and similar formulations are standard tantric code for particular letters used as bījas; their precise resolution depends on the specific matrix in use, and the text does not spell it out explicitly here.

The term "cizā" renders the Tibetan མཚོ་མཚོ་མཚོ་, which may transliterate a plant name of uncertain botanical identification; it is rendered phonetically.

- Several plant and wood names in this passage resist confident identification from the Tibetan transliterations alone. "Prakhā," "khatsa," "bāleta," "tāleśa," "dādhima," "mūlapattra," and "aruṇa wood" are approximate phonetic renderings from Sanskrit botanical names that are partially legible from context but not all certainly identifiable. "Cizā" continues from the preceding passage. "Padmaka" is the Himalayan cherry or *Prunus cerasoides*, standard in ritual contexts. "Khadira" is *Acacia catechu*, also standard.

The phrase rendered "born from the lotus of crystal water" involves some compression; the Tibetan describes a buddha figure arising from a water-crystal lotus, crystal in color and with a slight smile.

"Indranīla" is a blue sapphire or dark blue gemstone, here transliterated as it appears.

- The term translated as "dragon bone" renders a Tibetan term commonly used for a large snake or serpent (in some contexts also "thunderdrake"). Given the preceding chapter concerned snake venom and this chapter's heading for lightning, the compound "tiger bone and dragon bone" may refer to ritual ingredients from actual creatures or to mineral/herbal substances bearing these names. No emendation has been made; the literal rendering is preserved.

The phrase rendered "extinguish it with earth" is terse in the Tibetan. Literally it says "having offered into fire, kill with earth," meaning the fire is smothered with earth as part of the rite. The translation reflects this.

The text ends mid-sentence at the close of the seventh chapter, with the list of ritual ingredients running into the next passage. The translation faithfully reproduces this open ending as given.

- The text lists Trailokyavijaya, Yamāntaka, Hayagrīva, and Amogha Kabhrīkuṭi as the four directional wrathful deities. The last name is unusual; it may be a corrupt or abbreviated form of Amoghapāśa or a related deity. The transliteration is preserved as given in the Tibetan.

The phrase "three places" for anointing conventionally refers to forehead, throat, and heart in tantric ritual application, though the text does not specify.

- The form-realm divine hierarchy listed at the opening follows the standard Abhidharma cosmological schema of the seventeen or eighteen form-realm heavens. The names rendered here correspond to the Tibetan equivalents of the standard Sanskrit levels: Brahmapurohita, Mahābrahmā, Parīttābha, Apramāṇābha, Ābhāsvara, Parīttāśubha, Apramāṇāśubha, Śubhakṛtsna, Anabhraka, Puṇyaprasava, Bṛhatphala, Avṛha, Atapa, Sudṛśa, Sudarśana, and Akaniṣṭha — the translator has used the literal Tibetan rendering of each name in sequence rather than the Sanskrit, in keeping with the text's register.

The phrase rendered "five billion bodhisattvas" represents the Tibetan "bodhisattvas of five thousand hundred-thousands," i.e., five hundred million or five billion depending on the counting convention; the literal rendering is retained.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.